Nick Soderstrom

Senior project manager & operations lead

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Chicago, IL · Remote (US) or onsite Chicago

300+	18,000+	100%	Top 1%	Since 2015
Client contracts	Freelance hours billed	Upwork Job Success	Top Rated Plus on Upwork	Freelance

SUMMARY

Senior project manager and operations lead with 10+ years across federal research, universities, large corporations, startups and nonprofits. I take ownership of the moving parts, projects, timelines, tools, people and processes, so leadership can stay focused on growth. Lately also shipping iPhone apps and websites by directing AI models from brief to production. Freelance since 2015.

EXPERIENCE

Operations & Project Manager · Chief of Staff
2015 – Present

Freelance, mostly via Upwork

300+ contracts in project management, operations, CRM, executive support, events and web work. Key client roles below.

Digital Coordinator
2022 – 2026

SPARC.science · Bethesda, MD · Remote

Four years and 3,700+ hours supporting the SPARC Portal, an open neuroscience research platform.

- Ran the administrative side of a multi-institution research program: scheduling, tracking and follow-ups.
- Ran the program's public communications, including social media, for releases, events and new resources.

Account Manager
2024 – 2025

OFFX · Office Experience Company · California · Remote

Managed client relationships and kept orders on track from placement through delivery.

Project Manager · Video Production
2023 – 2024

BARBRI · Dallas, TX · Remote

Tracked post-production on hundreds of video courses, managing timelines with professors and creatives.

- 1,000+ hours with the team from late 2020; project manager for video production from March 2023.
- Managed production timelines and flagged slippage early enough to fix it.

Jr. Marketing Manager
2022 – 2024

Blackdove Art · Miami, FL · Remote

Guided clients from first touch through the sales and onboarding journey for a digital art platform.

Project Manager
2018 – 2022

Symplicity · Virginia · Remote

Coordinated with many colleges and internal groups to keep design projects on track for nearly four years.

- Gathered requirements, chased approvals and managed revisions with college clients.
- Kept the tracking that let the team see every active project at a glance.

Executive Assistant
2019 – 2020

Rippling · California · Remote

Scheduling and project coordination for multiple executives.

Front of House Manager
2017 – 2018

Pizzeria Bebu · Chicago, IL

Staff role on the opening-day team of a restaurant that went on to earn a Michelin Bib Gourmand.

- Managed 20+ people across teams, led front-of-house shifts and coached staff. Previously ServSafe certified.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Project & operations management
Scoping, timelines and milestones · Weekly reporting and async updates · Process design and documentation

Executive assistant support
Inbox and calendar ownership · Hiring pipelines and onboarding · Vendor and customer follow-up · QuickBooks bookkeeping: bills, AP/AR, reports

Systems & tools
Asana, ClickUp, Monday, Jira, Trello · Notion, Airtable, Confluence · Microsoft 365: Planner, Teams, SharePoint

Webinars, events & video
Zoom, OBS and livestream production · Premiere Pro, After Effects, Final Cut · Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign

CRM & automation
GoHighLevel, HubSpot, Salesforce, Zoho · Zapier and Power Automate · AI-assisted workflows and reporting

AI-directed builds, web & apps
Claude Code & Grok, prompt to production · Astro sites, SwiftUI apps, GitHub Pages · WordPress, Wix, Shopify updates

EDUCATION

DePaul University, Chicago, IL

Full contract history and client feedback on Upwork. References on request.